

New Centre Playbook

What to do when a shopping centre wants to buy and use the Valet App — step by step

Each centre gets its own separate, private copy of the app and its own private database — nothing is shared between centres. This keeps every centre's cars, customers and money completely separate and safe. It also means every new centre needs its own proper setup, covered in the phases below.

1 Before you say yes — get the details

Sales conversation

- Show them the app working — use the demo materials already made (the pitch report and demo run-sheet).
- Find out what they need: how many bays/cars, do they want card payments (Square), text messages to customers, car photo ID, hands-free shopping, car wash service.
- Get their centre details: name, address, phone number, logo files, and their parking price structure (how much per hour/tier, any free period, daily max).
- Find out if they already have hardware (an iPad/PC for the counter, a receipt/key-tag printer) or need to buy some.

2 Agree the business terms

You + business partner

- Decide how they pay: one-off setup fee, an ongoing monthly fee, a cut of revenue, or a mix — whatever you two agree makes sense for this deal.
- Decide what's included: the software, the setup work, staff training, and ongoing support — write down what's in and what costs extra.
- Put it in a written agreement (even simple) covering: what they're paying for, who owns the software (you do — they're licensed to use it, not buy the code), what happens to their data if they ever stop using it, and how support/fixes work.
- *Worth getting a lawyer to check the agreement wording once you have a template — not something to guess on.*
- Get it signed before starting the technical setup below (real work, so get the commitment first).

3 Set up their own separate system

Technical setup

- Copy the app's code into a new, separate online location (a new website address just for them).
- Create their own separate private database (completely separate from Chatswood Chase's and any other centre's).
- Set up the messaging/payment connections they asked for in Phase 1 (text messages, card payments, etc.) — each needs its own account/login for their centre.
- Replace the logo and icons with their branding.
- Enter their centre's name, address, phone, and pricing into the one settings area that controls the whole app.

There's already a full technical checklist for this exact process (**CLONE-NEW-CENTRE.md** in the app's files) — follow that step by step when you get to this phase.

4 Set up hardware and accounts

You / their team

- Get their counter device (iPad/tablet/PC) and key-tag printer set up and connected.
- If they're using card payments: pair their card machine to the device.
- Create logins for each of their staff members.

5 Train their staff

You / whoever runs training

- Walk them through: checking a car in, marking damage, checking a car out, handling a lost ticket, and (if they use it) hands-free shopping and car wash.
- There's already a ready-made staff training guide (**deck-staff-training.md**) — reuse it, just swap in their centre's name and screenshots.
- Do a hands-on practice run with real (test) cars before going live.

6 Test everything before go-live

You, before handing over

- Check the app loads with the right name and logo.
- Check a test car in — confirm the text message and printed key tag both show the new centre's name.
- Check a test car out — confirm the parking fee matches their pricing.
- Open a report — confirm it shows their centre's name and details.
- Double check the test data landed in **their** database, not anyone else's.
- Test anything extra they're using: card payment, photo car ID, pickup notifications.

7 Go live

Launch day

- Pick a start date and make sure their staff know it.
- Watch the first few days closely — check in on them, ask if anything's confusing or broken.
- Fix anything that comes up quickly — a smooth first week builds trust.

8 After they're live — ongoing

You + business partner, ongoing

- Be their point of contact for problems and questions.
- Send them a usage/performance report now and then (the app can already generate this).
- Bill them per your agreement from Phase 2.

Important: because every centre is a **separate copy** of the app, a fix or improvement made for one centre does **not** automatically reach the others — it has to be copied across to each centre's copy by hand. Keep a list of every centre running the app so nothing gets missed when you make a fix.

This is a working checklist — adjust it as you learn from each new centre. Ask for an updated copy any time the process changes.